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Frog



Toad



Salamander



Icthyophis (Caecilians)

Figure 2.26 Examples of Amphibia

2.4.7. Class: Amphibia

(G. *amphi*-both; *bios* -life)

Amphibians are the first vertebrates and tetrapods to live both in aquatic as well as terrestrial habitats.They are poikilothermic. Their body is divisible into the head and trunk and most of them have two pairs of limbs; tail may or may not be present. Their skin is smooth or rough, moist, pigmented and glandular. Eyes have eyelids and the tympanum represents the ear. Respiration is by gills, lungs and through the skin. Heart is three chambered. Kidneys are **mesonephric.** Sexes are separate and fertilization is external. They are oviparous and development is indirect. They show hibernation and aestivation.

Examples: *Bufo* (Toad), *Rana* (Frog), *Hyla* (Tree frog), *Salamandra* (Salamander), *Icthyophis* (Limbless amphibians) (Figure 2.26).

2.4.8. Class: Reptilia

(*L. repere* or *reptum* – to creep or crawl)

They are mostly terrestrial animals and their body is covered by dry, and cornified skin with epidermal scales or scutes. Reptiles have three chambered heart but four chambered in crocodiles. All are cold blooded amniotes (poikilotherms). Most reptiles lay **cleidoic eggs** with extraembryonic membranes like amnion, allantois, chorion and yolk sac. Excretion by metanephric kidneys and are uricotelic. They are monoecious. Internal fertilization takes place and all are oviparous.

Examples : *Chelone* (Turtle), *Testudo* (tortoise), *Hemidactylus* (House lizard), *Chameleon* (Tree lizard), *Calotes* (Garden lizard), *Draco* (Flying lizard), *Crocodilus* (crocodile), Poisonous snakes - *Naja* (Cobra), *Bangarus* (Krait), *Vipera* (Viper) (Figure 2.27).